



ST. MARTHA

PARISH & SCHOOL

Parent and Student Handbook 2025-2026

Table of Contents

Welcome	4
Staff Roster.....	5
Enrollment	6
Tuition.....	6-7
Withdrawal	7
Academic Policies.....	7-9
Attendance	
Parent Teacher Conferences	
Homework	
Makeup Work	
Report Cards	
NWEA	
Field Trips	
School Policies and General Information	10-12
Arrival and Dismissal	
Birthday Celebrations	
Recess	
Sports	
School Day Parking	
School Security	
Visitors	
Volunteer	
Uniform and Dress Code.....	12-14
Health Matters	15-17
Injuries at School	
Illness	
Immunizations	
Medications	
Pesticides	
Volunteers	

Safety and Emergencies.....	17-18
Drills	
School Closing	
Hazardous Travel Conditions	
School Crisis Plan	
Asbestos	
Child Protection Law	
Field Trips	
Weapons Policy	
Communication	19-20
School Speak	
News Notes	
Hazardous Travel Conditions	
Email	
Cell Phone/ Texting	
Conferences	
Field Trips	
Addressing Concerns	
Weekly Liturgy	20
Lunch Program.....	20-21
Discipline	21-29
Kid's Corner	30-31
Before School and After School Care	
St. Martha Guidelines for Technology (Separate Handbook).....	32
Copyright Information	32
Signature page	33

Dear Parents,

Welcome to Saint Martha School! We are looking forward to an exciting and productive year. As we begin our year of partnership, our desire is to integrate faith into school culture.

This handbook is intended to help all of us work cooperatively throughout the school year. Policies reflect our concern for the safety of all the children and our desire to provide a positive atmosphere for everyone.

Please go over the rules found on page 12 with your children. Keep this handbook in a safe place for your future reference.

Please complete the Handbook Addendum Page in your summer packet and return to school on Walk Through Day 2025.

*Sincerely,
Mrs. Andrea Patton*

School Mission Statement

In a loving, nurturing, Christ-like environment, St. Martha School guides each student to develop his or her unique ability and potential through prayer, study and service.

Philosophy

- We believe the family, as the primary educator, partners with us in the responsibility of preparing students for lifelong journey of faith and learning.
- We believe that knowledge of our Catholic beliefs, practices and traditions is critical to students to enable them to develop the moral strength to follow Christ in today's world.
- We believe that Catholic education requires active stewardship rooted in social justice and civic responsibility.
- We believe a challenging school wide curriculum rooted in gospel values provides students with optimal opportunities to succeed.
- We believe teachers engage in meaningful researched based professional development to improve skills for effective instruction.
- We believe students learn best when actively engaged and motivated to become lifelong learners.
- We believe in providing differentiated instructions so all students will achieve to their highest potential.

Diocesan Policy on the Human Body

Diocesan schools partner with families to educate and form students consistent with the teachings of our Lord, Jesus Christ and His Church, and so families are expected to live in accord with the Gospel values, particularly regarding actions and behaviors that are public. Students and parents (or legal guardians) shall conduct themselves in accord with their God-Given biological sex. Anything to the contrary notwithstanding.

Admission

Saint Martha School welcomes students of any race, religion, sex, color, national and ethnic origin, to all rights, privileges, programs, and activities generally accorded students at school or made available to students in this school. Every reasonable effort will be made by the Saint Martha School staff to meet the academic needs of each student and to help children modify inappropriate student behavior. Saint Martha reserves the right not to enroll, or to request that parents withdraw any student whose academic or behavioral needs cannot be met given the staff, materials, and facilities at Saint Martha School.

Staff Roster 2025-2026

Pastor: Father Ryan Riley frryan@st-martha.org
 Assistant to the Pastor: Father Mike Murray frmike@st-martha.org

Teacher	Room #	Subject and Grades	Email
Mrs. Patton	School Office	Principal	apatton@st-martha.org
Mrs. Farnsworth	School Office	Administrative Assistant	cfarnsworth@st-martha.org
Mrs. Belloli	116	Preschool	ebelloli@st-martha.org
Mrs. Lamke	118	Kindergarten	klamke@st-martha.org
Mrs. Marth	115	First Grade	kmarth@st-martha.org
Mrs. Vallejo	105	Second Grade	mvallejo@st-martha.org
Miss Jacobs	101	Third Grade	mjacobs@st-martha.org
Mrs. Plefka	103	Fourth Grade	jplefka@st-martha.org
Mr. Quintus	206	Fifth grade Homeroom, 4-8 Science, 7 Literature	aquintus@st-martha.org
Mrs. Richardson	204	Eighth Grade Homeroom, 5-8 English 8, Literature, 8 Religion	crichardson@st-martha.org
Miss Flint	208	Sixth Grade Homeroom, 5-8 Social Studies: 5,6 Literature	atahaney@st-martha.org
Mrs. C. Hall	207	Seventh Grade Homeroom (AM only) 5-8 Math	chall@st-martha.org
Mrs. Burkhardt	207	Seventh Grade Homeroom 5-7 (PM only) 5-7 Religion	hburkhardt@st-martha.org
Mrs. Williams	Parish Hall	Academic Interventionist	awilliams@st-martha.org
Mrs. Clark	Parish Hall	Spanish(K-8) Music (K-8)	cclark@st-martha.org
Mrs. Hanson	Gym	Physical Education (K-8), STEM/Library K-8	jhanson@st-martha.org
Mrs. Wylegala	Parish Hall	Visual Arts (K-8)	wylegalaliz@aol.com
Mrs. Muzzatti	Media Center	Technology (K-8)	wmuzzatti@st-martha.org
Mrs. Ardis	102	Violin	radis@st-martha.org
Mrs. Finnerty		Teacher mentor	
Mrs. Morgan Mrs. Rivet Miss Lopez Mrs. Rampe Miss Flamini	Preschool-2	Preschool and Elementary School Aides and Playground Supervisors	
Ashley Sheer	Cafeteria	Lunchroom Supervisor	
Mrs. Fletcher		Kids Corner Supervisor	

Hours

Before School Care:	7:20 A.M. - 7:50 A.M.
School Day:	8:00 A.M. - 3:25 P.M.
After School Care:	3:25 P.M. - 6:00 P.M.
Half Day Pre-school:	8:00 A.M. - 11:30 A.M.
Full Day Pre-School:	8:00 A.M. - 3:15 P.M.
Lunch/ Recess	11:25 A.M. - 12:20 P.M.
School Office Hours:	7:45 A.M. - 3:45 P.M.

Enrollment Policy

1. St. Martha School admits students during two consecutive periods to be announced annually in the following order:

First Period -	<i>Re-enrollment for St. Martha School and Preschool students/siblings in good standing under the Tuition Policy.</i>
Second Period-	<i>For children of the parish and community at large. Enrollment/waiting list status will be announced at the conclusion of the period.</i>

Tuition Policy

1. Tuition rates and fees will be established each year by the Pastor and the Parish Finance Council.
2. Tuition assistance may be granted to families who can provide evidence of real financial need. **Financial Aide Applications are due to the Diocese of Lansing by March of the upcoming school year.** Families requesting tuition assistance will need to submit an application with supporting financial documentation to FACTS, who will then determine family's need. St. Martha School may grant tuition assistance as well. Once need is assessed, the family will be notified and will be invited to meet with our accounting team to determine the assistance that can be provided.
3. **Tuition/Fee Payments**
 - All families will sign up for **FACTS** upon enrollment/ re-enrollment
 - The FACTS program is a collection medium that assures orderly and timely cash flow to meet the needs of St. Martha School.
 - FACTS offers several schedules to spread the payments over a (12) month period with the option for automatic bank account withdrawals or credit card payments. If you choose to pay in full, you are able to do so using the **FACTS** Program as well.
 - Lunch tickets, childcare, and other school fees will be collected through the **FACTS**.
4. If a special need arises during the year due to unforeseen circumstances, immediate contact should be made with the principal to address the solution of the tuition payment. The situation will remain confidential and can be readily resolved through the parents' initiative.
5. **Tuition Credit-Raise Right Program**

Through the St. Martha Raise Right Program, your family purchases gift cards to restaurants, gas stations, retail shops or anywhere your family frequently shops. These gift cards are purchased at face value. A \$100 gift card to Speedway costs you \$100. By purchasing the gift card through the Raise Right program, you will earn a percentage of the card's value to be applied to your child's tuition. This "rebate" rate depends on the vendor. We keep track of all the rebates your family accumulates and return 90% of the accumulated rebate back to the

family in the form of a tuition credit. The remaining 10% of the rebate is held back to cover administrative costs (shipping, bank fees, etc.). Although some schools use the Raise Right program as a fundraiser, at St. Martha the vast majority of the rebate that your family accumulates directly benefits your family. Credits are reported to on a quarterly or annual basis (it's up to you), reducing your future tuition. Click on the links below for more information:

[Raise Right Program Information](#)

[Raise Right Participant Form](#)

6. Tuition/Fee payments must be current at the end of the semester or re-enrollment will not be permitted.

Withdrawal Policy

1. Registration and book fees are nonrefundable.
2. Fees for extra-curricular classes (strings, drama club, etc.) are nonrefundable.
3. Tuition will be refunded according to the following schedule:
 - 100% of semester tuition will be refunded for withdrawals during the 1st through the 5th full day of class.
 - 50% of semester tuition will be refunded for withdrawals during the 6th through 10th full day of class.
 - No semester tuition will be refunded for withdrawals after the 10th full day of class.

Academic Policies

Attendance

The Michigan School Code states that it is the responsibility of the parent(s) to see that their children between the ages of six and sixteen are in attendance at school. Good attendance is important in order for children to be successful in school. All students are expected to attend school regularly. It is important for students to be on time for classes in order to obtain maximum benefit from the instructional program and to develop habits of punctuality, self-discipline, and responsibility. Chronic absence problems will be referred to the Ingham County truancy coordinator.

- Chronically absent means absent for 10% or more of the enrolled school days in a school year.
- Truant means a child who has ten (10) or more unexcused absences per school year. A child should be counted as truant only once in a given school year. Once deemed truant, a child shall be monitored throughout the school year until improved attendance is consistent.

Parents are strongly urged to arrange family vacations during scheduled vacation periods.

Regular student attendance and punctuality is based on a partnership between home and school in promoting responsible attendance habits. This is an essential component of school success.

Some absences are unavoidable. Those due to personal illness, sickness or death in the family, and medical appointments *which cannot be made outside* of school time, are understandable.

When your child is going to be absent, please call the school between 7:45 and 8:00 A.M. or email the teacher and school secretary by 8:00 am.

If it is necessary for a student to be excused during the day, an email of explanation should be sent to the teacher and the school secretary. The child is then to be picked up in the office and signed out. When returning, the child needs to check in at the school office. A student will not be released to anyone who is not listed on the pick-up authorization form.

Tardiness

It is important for students to be on time for classes in order to obtain maximum benefit from the instructional program and to develop habits of punctuality, self-discipline, and responsibility.

Punctuality is responsible and considerate behavior. It is imperative that every family make a great effort to avoid tardiness. It interrupts class lessons when the teacher has to stop teaching to change the lunch count and attendance records. It is distracting to have late students moving around lockers and desks with book bags and papers. Considerable time is lost to the whole group when this happens several times a morning every day. Occasional tardiness may be unavoidable, but beyond that is cause for great concern. If excessive tardiness is occurring, an email of concern will be sent from the teacher and a meeting to address the concern may be necessary.

- If you know that your child will be tardy, please email the teacher and school secretary (or call) and let them know if he/she will need to order a lunch.
- Students may enter the building at 7:50 am. **If your child is not in the classroom by 8:00 am, he/she will be marked tardy.**

Please remember that the students depend on you, the parent, to get them to school on time.

Parents of tardy students are respectfully asked not to accompany the late student to the classroom. This only compounds the interruption to the class.

Students who arrive after 10:00 A.M. or leave before 1:00 P.M. will be considered absent a half day.

If in a school year, you are late everyday by...	You will have lost approximately...	Or you would have missed approximately...
5 Minutes	3 days from school	18 lessons
10 Minutes	7 days from school	35 lessons
15 Minutes	10 days from school	50 lessons
20 Minutes	14.5 days from school	73 lessons
30 Minutes	22 days from school	110 lessons

Parent/Teacher Conferences

Parent/Teacher Conferences will be held twice a year for Preschool – 8th Grade.

The Fall Conference is required and the Spring Conference is optional, but a teacher may request a conference if necessary. Parents are encouraged to keep in contact with their child's teacher(s) as well as log onto SchoolSpeak regularly to check student progress.

Homework

Homework is a valuable component of the learning process. It enriches and extends what was learned in class and helps to establish good study habits. Most times homework is work that students do not complete during the school day. Students are responsible for completing and returning it by the due date. Homework may include daily reading, math fact practice, and studying for tests. Students grades 1 and 2 may have 15-20 minutes home study; in grades 3 and 4 the home study time increases to 30-45 minutes; in grades 5 and 6 homework may take 60 -75 minutes; in grades 7 and 8, 60 – 90 minutes. Times may vary among individual students.

Please note: Middle school homework assignments that need to be printed must be printed at home. Teachers and the school office are not responsible for printing homework assignments. We want to promote organization and responsibility among our students and the accountability for getting homework done at home is a priority in preparation for the expectations of high school.

Make-Up Work

Time away from school due to travel and vacations is highly discouraged. While students are able to make up written assignments, they miss valuable instruction time. When it is necessary for your child to be absent from school for a vacation, **please notify the teacher.** While it may not be possible to provide assignments in advance, students may take their books (or take copies of pages) and do the normally assigned work such as the "next" spelling unit or the "next" chapter etc. It is up to the teacher to decide what work will be made up. Worksheets will be saved during the absence and given to the student when he/she returns to school. When students are absent, they will be given one day for each day they are absent to make up work. It is the responsibility of the student/ family to complete and turn in the work and to notify the teacher that he/she is ready to take any tests that have been missed while the student was away. Work that is not required by the teacher to be made up will receive a "no credit".

Report Cards

Report cards are issued four times a year, at the end of each quarter, in grades K-8. They are posted on SchoolSpeak and it is the responsibility of the parent to review them and sign them electronically.

North West Evaluation Association (NWEA) Testing

NWEA Testing will be administered 3 times a year: Fall, Winter & Spring for grades 3-8. These are diagnostic tests which identify individual strengths and weaknesses and monitor growth.

Field Trips/Class Trips

Field trips are an important part of education. They are the curriculum for the day and are not optional. Parents will be notified when field trips are scheduled and will receive information about the event as well as a permission form to complete. All field trips/class trips will be kept within a 100-mile radius unless special permission is granted by the principal. Drivers and chaperones are often needed. If a parent chooses not to allow a student to ride with the designated field trip driver, it is expected that the parent will make other arrangements to get his child to the field trip. Your volunteer help is welcome and appreciated. **Please note:** When driving on a field trip, drivers must:

1. Have completed the required Virtus training.
2. Have completed the State of Michigan Request for Central Registry Clearance.
3. Filled out the required diocesan Driver Information Form, which includes insurance information and a copy of a valid driver's license.
4. Drivers may not talk/text on cell phones while driving on a field trip.

*All driver forms are sent home in the summer packet and may be found on SchoolSpeak.

Younger siblings or additional guests will not be permitted to attend school field trips with their parent chaperones, unless otherwise specified by the classroom teacher.

School Policies and General Information

Arrival and Dismissal

Morning Drop Off -Preschool/Kindergarten

Parents will park and walk their children to the preschool and kindergarten rooms through the courtyard. Please give hugs and goodbyes at the door. Siblings of kindergarteners and preschoolers should enter this way as well.

Morning Drop Off- 1st-8th Grade

Students in Grades 1-8 will be dropped off using the school entrance carline. Parents are to remain in the cars. The first car will pull all the way up to the curve by the light post. Do not allow your child to leave the car until they are close to the building. Once your child exits, you may carefully pull out of the carline to exit.

Late arrivals-Pull up in the carline to drop off your child. Have them ring the doorbell and the student will be let in.

****Students do not have access to their classrooms until 7:50am. Student not attending morning care should wait until 7:50am to enter the building. This allows teachers time to prepare for the day without disruption. Students arriving early must go to morning care to be supervised.**

Preschool and Kindergarten Dismissal

Parents will park and pick up their child at the classroom door or in the courtyard, depending on the weather conditions. Siblings in 1-8 will be picked up in the front of the school.

When exiting, please remember that due to limited sight distance, MDOT does not allow a left turn out of the west driveway...ever.

Dismissal-1- 8th Dismissal

Please always remember to drive slowly and with caution while on St. Martha grounds.

There are two choices for dismissal in Grades 1-8

Option 1: Parents who would like to park may do so in the north parking lot (where the children walk to get to the playground). **Children will not be dismissed to their cars, rather the parents will need to walk up and personally take their child.** Do not wave your child to the car from the parking lot. Do not park in the south lot and walk your children in front of the carline.

Option 2: For those who choose to continue the carline option and have your child delivered to your car, you will circle the edge of the parking lot and turn at the drive right after the *Memorial for the Unborn* and pull around and all the way up the light post.

Let your child know what method you will be using so we can assist them and get them to the correct spot. All children will be dismissed from the north entrance/exit and will stay with their teacher until they are either picked up in person or by car.

* Never zig zag through the parking lot or cut through lines.

* If a student is being picked up by someone other than a parent, their name must be listed on the pick-up authorization form and will be required to present ID until the staff is able to identify them.

Birthday Celebrations

Parents are asked to check with the classroom teacher about bringing birthday treats for celebrations during the school day. Party invitations brought to school are permitted, but only if the whole class or all the girls or all the boys are invited. When only a few school friends are invited, parents are asked to mail invitations and promote discretion by encouraging students not to discuss party plans at school. Please refrain from sending in nut products if your child is in a nut-restricted classroom.

Parents are also asked not have gifts such as balloons, floral arrangements etc. delivered to school as they will be left in the office to be picked up by the student at the end of the day.

Students may wear free dress on their birthday. If a student celebrates a birthday on a day we are not scheduled to be in school, the teacher will work with the student to assign an alternative day for the birthday free dress.

Recess

Free play is an important part of a child's life. A period of recess will be provided every day at the noon hour. Fresh air and exercise are good for the children, so weather permitting they will go outside. Children will go outside if it is 10° or above actual or wind-chill temperatures. **Children should be prepared each day and dress appropriately.** In the winter, snowpants, boots, and other warm clothing is necessary. A note from a physician is required to be excused from outside play.

Sports

While St. Martha School recognizes the importance of team sports, such valued programs are not factored into tuition costs and rely on parent volunteers for organization. St. Martha School encourages parents to coach and promote Christ-like sportsmanship. All sports are extracurricular. Students must attend school the day of a practice or game to be eligible to practice or play a school sponsored extra-curricular event.

Any team spirit wear created using the St. Martha Logo needs to be approved by the school principal **before** it is manufactured.

School Day Parking

Parent volunteers who are working in the building during the hours of 8:15am and 3:15pm should park in the south parking lot, closest to the church entrance. The north parking, closest to the school entrance should remain free from parked cars while school is in session. This will create safer travel to and from the playground each day.

School Security

The school entrance doors and access doors to classroom hallways will be locked daily at 8:05am. If you are entering the building after 8:05am, please use the school entrance and ring the doorbell to check in. To keep order and efficiency in the building, please let the office or your child's teacher know when you'll be here so they can have a staff member available to give you access to the building.

Visitors

Saint Martha School welcomes visitors. Please make arrangements with the teacher and principal if you or other family members wish to visit and observe. For reasons of security and safety, **all visitors/volunteers must first register in the school office.** To minimize interruptions in the classroom, parents who bring forgotten items to their child should leave them labeled in the office.

* Parents are welcome to stay for morning prayer and Mass. If you choose to join us, please park in the south lot and come in through the church entrance after dropping off your child(ren).

Volunteers

Volunteers are needed and appreciated. **Each family is asked to donate a minimum of 20 hours of volunteer time per school year.** Each family will be given a list of volunteer job descriptions and will be asked to fill out a volunteer form to be turned in as specified.

Because small children can be disruptive to the classroom routine, we ask that volunteers not bring infants or pre-school age children with them.

Anyone who volunteers with St. Martha School students (classroom, field trips, coaching etc.) is required to attend one Diocesan mandated Virtus "Protecting God's Children" class. Class dates and times will be posted in Newsnotes. In addition, background (ICHAT) checks are required for anyone who volunteers with students or if driving on a field trip. Fingerprinting may also be required if someone has not lived in Michigan for the past 10 years and who is volunteering with students.

For reasons of security and safety, all volunteers must first register in the school office.

Uniforms and Dress Code **(See Uniform Booklet)**

St. Martha School is a Catholic school which maintains the right to establish a uniform dress code for its students. It is recognized that proper school attire and good grooming are conducive to a student's educational and social development. School attire should always be within the limits of Christian good taste with emphasis on modesty. Our uniform code reinforces the belief that children are important not because of what they possess, but because of who they are. Appropriate clothing and neat appearance have a positive effect on student learning and conduct. In addition, uniforms provide a sense of unity.

Saint Martha students wear uniforms purchased through [MY APLUS UNIFORMS](#) (MAPU) in Lansing, MI. These uniforms will be labeled with our logo and are the official uniform for St. Martha.

*Coats, sweatshirts or blankets may not be worn in the building. Students must wear the required uniform sweaters if they get cold. (The rooms are kept at a comfortable temperature).

Non-uniform/Free Dress Days

All half days are non-uniform days unless otherwise noted.

- Students must wear modest, school appropriate clothing.
- Footwear must also be modest and comfortable (no high heels, no loose-fitting sandals, flip-flops etc.).
- Shorts of appropriate length for both boys and girls (no shorter than fingertips with arms fully extended down the leg) or capris may be worn during August, September, October and after Spring Break.
- Skirts of appropriate length for girls (no shorter than fingertips with arms fully extended down the leg)
- Students may not wear: pajamas, tank tops, crop tops, spaghetti (thin) straps, tight clothing, and t-shirts with inappropriate pictures, words, political endorsements, or controversial statements.
- Students may not wear hoods or hats in school.
- If you have any question on what is appropriate, please contact the office prior to wearing this item of clothing.

Students may wear “free dress” on their birthday. If a student celebrates a birthday on a day we are not scheduled to be in school, the teacher will work with the student to assign an alternative day for the birthday free dress.

Spirit Wear Days

Spirit Wear Days are special days to show our St. Martha School pride! Spirit Wear Days are not free dress days. Students may only wear official St. Martha tops, purchased through [MY APLUS UNIFORMS](#) (MAPU) Uniforms or Mileage Club or Fundraiser T-shirts. When appropriate, team jerseys are permitted but t-shirts are to be worn under anything sleeveless. Regular or athletic shoes with socks should be worn. On spirit wear days, students may wear comfortable, modest track pants/shorts at an appropriate length. Jeans and appropriate length shorts, skirts, or skorts are also permitted. Students may also wear Lansing Catholic High School spirit wear. The school uniform is to be worn if the above guidelines cannot be followed, as it is the ultimate "spirit wear"!

General Guidelines:

- Hair should be neat in appearance and kept out of eyes.
- Make up, jewelry, purses, or other accessories are not permitted.
- Girls with pierced ears may wear small stud earrings. No hoops or earrings that dangle.
- Necklaces with a small cross or religious medal are permitted.
- A plain watch or basic Fitbit/activity tracker may be worn in grades 3-8. All texting/messaging capabilities must be disabled.
- No watches of any kind allowed in grades K-2.
- Nail polish on natural nails is accepted ***but artificial nails of any fashion may not be worn.***

Parental support of the Uniform and Dress Code is appreciated. Assist your child in making appropriate clothing choices. Please be aware that the St. Martha School uniform policy will be enforced and failure to follow it will result in the students changing into something from our care closet or they may call home to bring appropriate items in for the student. Repeat offenses will result in disciplinary action.

Summer uniform and shorts may only be worn in August, September, October, and after Spring Break (April, May, June).

Uniform Guidelines K-8

K-4 Girls	5-8 Girls	K-4 Boys	5-8 Boys
The following items must be purchased at MAPU: Gray plaid jumper hemmed to no higher than 1" above the knee. White blouse with Peter Pan collar (short or long sleeve) Gray monogrammed vest or sweater (winter uniform with pants) Gray monogrammed cardigan (optional with jumper-but recommended) MAPU hair accessories (optional) Pants/ Shorts Option Navy pants or shorts with a black, brown, or navy belt (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) with St. Martha polo or white short sleeve blouse with Peter Pan collar. (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) Purchase anywhere: Black, brown, or navy belt (must be worn with a tucked in shirt). Elastic with metal clasp is permitted for K-4. <i>(K students are excused from wearing a belt until their motor skills have developed).</i> White turtleneck to wear under jumper. Black/gray shorts or leggings to wear under the jumper for modesty Solid white, gray, navy or black ankle or fold over socks or tights. No footie or "no show" socks or socks in other colors Gray, maroon, black or white <u>simple</u> hair accessories (optional) Black or gray Mary Jane style shoe (1 ½ heel max) with buckle or elastic strap or black or gray athletic sneaker. Sneakers should not be multi-colored (including logos) or have colored laces. No high tops or boots. K and 1: Velcro straps or slip-ons-no laces please! PE CLASS: Supportive anti-skid shoes-any color. No neon or light up shoes. These will remain in school.	The following items must be purchased at MAPU: Gray plaid skirt hemmed to no higher than 1" above the knee. Long or short sleeve monogrammed polo or short sleeve oxford shirt (tucked in) Maroon monogrammed vest or cardigan (Required winter uniform) MAPU hair accessories (optional) Pants/ Shorts Option Gray pants or shorts with a black, brown, or navy belt (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) with St. Martha polo or white short sleeve blouse with Peter Pan collar. (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) Purchase anywhere: Black, brown, or gray belt (must be worn with a tucked in shirt). Black/gray shorts or leggings to wear under the jumper for modesty. Solid white, gray, navy or black ankle or fold over socks or tights. No footie or "no show" socks or socks in other colors Gray, maroon, black or white <u>simple</u> hair accessories (optional) Black or gray Mary Jane style shoe (1 ½ heel max) with buckle or elastic strap or black or gray athletic sneaker or slip-ons. Sneakers should not be multi-colored (including logos) or have colored laces. No high tops or boots. PE CLASS: Supportive anti-skid shoes-any color. No neon or light up shoes Grades 6-8: PE Uniform must be purchased from MAPU (required) Long sleeve or short sleeve gray monogrammed t-shirt and monogrammed maroon shorts.	The following items must be purchased at MAPU: Navy pants or shorts with a black, brown, or navy belt (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) Short or long-sleeve white polo, tucked in at all times. Gray monogrammed vest or sweater (winter uniform) Purchase anywhere: Black, brown, or navy belt (must be worn with a tucked in shirt). Elastic with metal clasp is permitted for K-4. <i>(K students are excused from wearing a belt until their motor skills have developed).</i> Solid white, gray, navy, or black ankle or crew socks. No footie or "no show" socks or socks in other colors All black or gray athletic shoes or all black or gray slip-on style shoes. Sneakers should not be multi-colored (including logos) or have colored laces. No high tops or boots. PE CLASS: Supportive athletic, anti-skid shoes-any color. No neon or light up shoes. Grades 6-8: PE Uniform must be purchased from MAPU (required) Long sleeve or short sleeve gray monogrammed t-shirt and monogrammed maroon shorts.	The following items must be purchased at MAPU: Gray pants or shorts with a black, brown, or navy belt (shorts are summer/spring uniform only) Short or long-sleeve white polo, tucked in at all times. Maroon monogrammed vest or sweater (winter uniform) Purchase anywhere: Black, brown, or gray belt (must be worn with a tucked in shirt). Solid white, gray, navy, or black ankle or crew socks. No footie or "no show" socks or socks in other colors All black or gray athletic shoes or all black or gray slip-on style shoes. Sneakers should not be multi-colored (including logos) or have colored laces. No high tops or boots. PE CLASS: Supportive athletic, anti-skid shoes-any color. No neon or light up shoes. Grades 6-8: PE Uniform must be purchased from MAPU (required) Long sleeve or short sleeve gray monogrammed t-shirt and monogrammed maroon shorts.

Health Matters

Food Allergies, Intolerances, and Nut Restrictions

Parents are responsible for notifying both the school office and the classroom teacher of any food allergies or intolerances their child may have. This information is essential to help us take appropriate precautions and create a safe environment for all students.

Classrooms may be designated as *nut-restricted* if a child with a diagnosed nut allergy is enrolled. However, students are still permitted to bring peanut butter and other nut products in their lunches. Those bringing nut-containing items will be asked to sit in a designated area at their lunch table to help prevent cross-contact.

To support the health and safety of all students:

- Children should **not share food** with classmates, especially items containing nuts.
- Students who eat foods with nuts should **wash their hands thoroughly** afterward.

While we will do our very best to minimize risk and promote safety, we cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment. Families should educate their children about their specific dietary needs and how to manage them during the school day.

EpiPen Policy for Students with Severe Allergies

If your child has a life-threatening allergy that may require the use of an EpiPen, it is essential that the school is fully informed. Parents must provide the following:

- A **current Allergy Action Plan** signed by the child's physician.
- At least **one labeled, unexpired EpiPen** (preferably two), to be kept at school.
- Clear instructions regarding when and how the EpiPen should be administered.

EpiPens will be stored in a secure but easily accessible location, and staff will be trained in their use. If a student is authorized by their physician and parents to carry their EpiPen, documentation must be on file with the school office.

While we take every precaution to prevent exposure to allergens, we cannot guarantee an allergen-free environment. Open communication, preparedness, and partnership between parents and school staff are key to keeping children with severe allergies safe.

Injuries at School

Every precaution will be taken to ensure a safe, comfortable environment for students. However, if a child is injured, basic first aid will be administered; cuts and scrapes will be washed and bandaged, bumps will have ice applied, etc. Emergency procedures are in place for serious injuries. If a serious injury occurs, parents will be notified as soon as proper care to make the student safe is given.

Illness

Children should not be sent to school when they are ill. Specifically, children should stay home if they

- are too ill to go outside
- show signs of a fresh cold or have a cold so bad that it needs to be treated with cough syrup or antihistamines, etc.
- have an elevated temperature
- have been on antibiotics fewer than 24 hours
- have vomited during the previous 24 hours
- have had diarrhea during the previous 24 hours
- have skin lesions or rashes that have not been identified and treated

A note from your physician is required if a child is to stay in from recess for reasons of illness.

Please notify the school office of any communicable diseases as we are required to report these to the health department.

If an illness occurs at school, the child will be isolated from the rest of the children and made comfortable while the parents are notified to pick up.

Parents should be **easily** accessible throughout the school day. If you are unable to answer your phone at any time during school hours, please make sure that your voicemail is not full and able to receive messages. If we are not able to reach you in a reasonable amount of time, the student's emergency contacts listed on their emergency card will be called.

Immunizations

Michigan law requires that children be fully immunized before entering school for the first time.

Parents must present a certificate of immunization from their physician or submit a signed waiver by the 1st day of school. An updated immunization certificate is due prior to a child entering the 7th grade.

Medications

All medications **should be given at home** whenever possible. In order for medications to be given at school, a parent must fill out a form giving permission and instructions. Prescription medications must be brought to the school office in the original labeled container by the parent. Prescription medications must have the physician's name, child's name, name and strength of the medicine and instructions. **Please note that cough drops and all non-prescription medications are strongly discouraged.**

Supporting Student Mental Health and Safety

At St. Martha School, we are committed to supporting the emotional and mental well-being of all our students. As part of our continued efforts to provide a safe and caring environment, we want to share with you our approach to supporting students who may be experiencing mental health challenges such as anxiety, depression, or emotional distress, including any expression or threat of harm to self or others.

We take all concerns seriously. Whether a student expresses feelings of sadness, anxiety, or makes a statement related to harming themselves or someone else, our staff responds immediately and with care.

- Our first priority is safety. If a student appears to be in crisis or makes a threat of self-harm or harm to others, the student is never left alone, and the administration are alerted right away. All threats of suicidal ideation (oral, verbal, written, or drawn) will be taken seriously. Parents are contacted as soon as possible. Student will be sent home and should be evaluated by a physician as soon as possible. Emergency room evaluation is appropriate when a child is expressing active suicidal thoughts, intent, plan, or behavior. If ever a targeted threat of violence is made will be reviewed by the school BTAM team including local law enforcement.
- Supportive response, not punishment. We view mental health concerns as health matters, not disciplinary issues. Our team works to provide support through communication with families, and referrals to outside professionals.
- Collaboration is key. In some situations, a student may be asked to stay home temporarily while we ensure their safety and develop a plan of care. A re-entry meeting and a doctor's note may be required. We will work closely with you on any next steps.
- Education and prevention. Our staff receives training to recognize signs of emotional distress, and students are given age-appropriate tools to help manage their feelings and seek help when needed.

- We ask for your partnership in this important effort. School personnel will continue to report any concerning behavior to the parent. In addition, if your child is struggling emotionally, or if you have concerns about their mental health, please do not hesitate to reach out to us. Together, we can ensure that every child receives the care and compassion they need to thrive.

Supports

- Your child's pediatrician – A good starting point for a referral or screening

Community Mental Health Resources

If you are concerned about your child's mental health, the following organizations may be helpful:

- CEI-CMH Families Forward (517) 346-8200; Access Center (517)346-8318
- Michigan State University Outpatient Child and Adolescent Psychiatric Clinic: 517-353-3070
- Mid-Mitten Child and Adolescent Psychiatry (Samantha Kennedy, DO): 517-347-8420
- University of Michigan Outpatient Psychiatric Services: 734-764-0231
- Pine Rest Christian Mental Health Services: 616-281-6446
- Parents may reach out to P2P if additional guidance is needed with respect to obtaining psychiatric services or if access to care questions arise. (www.prevent2protect.msu.edu)

Please don't hesitate to reach out to your child's teacher or administration if you notice signs of emotional struggle or simply want to talk through a concern. Together, we can make sure every child feels supported, safe, and cared for academically, emotionally, and spiritually.

Pesticides

As a part of Saint Martha School's pest management program, pesticides are occasionally applied. You have the right to be informed of any pesticide application made to the school grounds or buildings. If you need notification of pesticide application, please let the school office know.

Safety and Emergencies

Fire/Tornado Drills

In accordance with Michigan law, students will practice drills to learn to exit the building quickly and safely.

Tornados

In the event of a tornado watch, weather conditions will be monitored and teachers alerted so they will be prepared to take cover. Should a tornado warning be issued the children will be sheltered until the all-clear signal is given. However, as if with any bad weather, parents who wish to pick up their children may do so.

Lockdown Drills

The purpose of lockdown is to secure the school so the students and staff are protected during an event that may be dangerous or threatening. Staff and students will practice lockdown procedures as specified by Michigan Law.

During a lockdown, no-one (including staff, students, & parents) is permitted to enter or exit the building until the all-clear is given.

School Closing

Local TV stations will be contacted when St. Martha School will be closed due to bad weather conditions. All parents will be immediately notified via email and text messaging, and the closing will be posted on our school Facebook Page. If school must close while classes are in session, the children should be picked up as soon as possible. If it is impossible for a parent to pick-up their child on such occasions, other arrangements should be

made so that they can go home with a friend or be picked-up by another person. When children are not picked up within the hour, those persons listed on the emergency card will be called to do so.

Hazardous Travel Conditions

Children come to school from communities of varying distances where weather conditions may differ. Even though St. Martha is open, parents who feel that driving conditions are unsafe should keep their children home until weather conditions improve. A call to the school office should be made to notify us that your child will not be in school. When weather becomes dangerous or threatening during the school day, parents who are concerned may pick up their children.

School Crisis Plan

St. Martha School has a school crisis plan, developed in partnership with the Meridian Township Police and Fire Department to address emergencies such as fires, shootings, accidents, as well as biological, radiological, chemical, and other terrorist activities.

In accordance with Diocesan policy during a period of heightened state of alert, St. Martha School will institute a locked down condition. The school has the Lockout system and teachers are trained in using it. The school is equipped with cameras inside and outside the building. During these times be aware that the school doors will be locked. Communication to families will take place as quickly as possible through email and text message. **In an emergency, please leave the phone lines open so staff can communicate with authorities.**

Asbestos Hazard Emergency Response Act

In compliance with the US Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and Asbestos Hazard Emergency Response Act (AHERA), in 1990 we performed inspections of each of our school buildings for asbestos containing building materials. The inspection findings and asbestos management plans have been on file in the school administrative office since that time. The EPA requires us to perform an inspection of asbestos materials every three years.

Child Protection Law

All school personnel have participated in Virtus Training to ensure a safe environment for our students as well as fingerprinted and background checks. In accordance with state law, educational, catechetical, and youth ministry administrators and all other school and parish employees shall be required to report immediately any suspected cases of child abuse or neglect involving a student under the age of 18 to the proper authority. The Chairperson of the Diocesan Department of Education and Catechesis shall be notified, in writing of the reporting of the suspected case of child abuse or neglect.

Weapons Policy: Public Act 250 of 1995

Under Section 1311 of the Michigan School Code (MCL 380.1311), school districts are required to expel a student who possess a dangerous weapon in a weapon free school zone, school building or on school grounds. This revision became effective December 29, 1995.

Communication

FACTS SIS

St. Martha School's primary communication tool. All school families will be given information necessary to access the FACTS SIS website. Once you are registered, you will receive an email with log on information. **Please store your username and password in a safe place so you can regularly access this tool.** Homework Assignments, grades, and general school information will be posted here.

News Notes

The weekly newsletter is emailed to parents every Tuesday. Unless there is an unforeseen circumstance, there will always be Tuesday Newsnotes. This is an important piece of communication that should be read regularly to ensure that parents are aware of what is happening at school.

Email

Teachers/Staff are asked to reply to emails from parents within 24 hours. Please note that this does not apply to weekends or holidays. Emails received on a Friday should not expect an answer until the next Monday etc.

Cell Phone/Texting

Due to the “family atmosphere” at St. Martha School, some teachers/staff may share (but are not required) their cell phone numbers. Parents are asked to **use discretion** when using these numbers keeping in mind that teachers and staff are busy with students during the school day. **Please call the school office for messages to or about children as teachers don’t often have the time to check their email before the end of the day.**

Conferences

Parents who wish to meet with Mrs. Patton or another staff member should email or call to set up an appointment.

Addressing Academic or Behavior Concerns

When an incident or concern takes place during the school day, the teacher will reach out if they feel necessary. The goal is to build a community and relationships. Incidences in school are handled with integrity and love and are often dealt with a dialogue between the teacher and student(s) so the students can learn and grow from the experience.

St. Martha School is called to be set apart and to love one another as God loves us. We welcome parent engagement and collaboration. A strong home/ school partnership is critical to the students’ success. The following process is modeled after what Jesus offered ([Mt 18:15-17](#)) and should be followed when addressing your concerns. (See p. 18)

1. If your child comes home and communicates something that happened at school, we suggest you do the following:
 - Ask your child questions to get a full understanding of what has occurred
 - Children often leave out information when it could get them in trouble
 - Stay calm-assume positive intent from staff and seek information
 - Keep the matter between your family and the school
 - Sharing concerns with other families can cause misinformation to spread
 - FIRST-contact the relevant teacher/ staff member directly in a respectful way
 - Simply share your concerns and be willing to work collaboratively to explore possible solutions
 - Listen to what the teacher has to say
 - The teacher may have to take time to gather information before responding to get an accurate picture
 - Repeat to your child what the teacher has communicated to you
 - Discuss any variations with the teacher
 - If needed, the teacher, parent, and student can conference together
2. If after genuine collaboration and open communication with the teacher/staff member the issue remains unresolved, the next step would be to address the concern with all parties with the principal. If the concern is with the principal, follow Step #1 with the principal.
3. If after attempts with genuine collaboration and open communication and is not resolved, the next step is to go to the Pastor.

If you first contact the principal, the initial response will be to ask you to reach out to the teacher or staff

member.

The faculty and staff will not discuss another student's personal information including consequences that were received following an incident. Kindly remember, that our students are children and our job is to form them with virtue and assist them in growing into Catholic Christian disciples. This process allows our community to foster relationships, transparency, and healthy communication.

Weekly School Liturgy

The Eucharistic Liturgy and religious education are the foundation of our values-based Catholic education. A school Mass will be held each Thursday at **8:20 A.M.** The children will help prepare the liturgy. Gr. 4-8 will attend Mass on Mondays at 8:20 A.M. and Gr. 5-8 will attend Mass on Fridays at 8:20 A.M.

*Parents are welcome to attend our student Masses. If you will be attending, please park in the south parking lot, near the church entrance and enter and exit through those doors. The school doors will be locked after morning drop off.

Lunch Program

Hot Lunch Program

Lansing Catholic High School provides St. Martha School with a catered hot lunch and milk *almost* every day. A monthly menu is also provided by Lansing Catholic and will be posted in News Notes.

Our lunch program is managed through the FACTS Student Information System. Each family maintains one account for all of their children. No lunch tickets are required. Families will receive a notification directly from FACTS when their balance drops to \$10.00 or below, prompting them to add funds as needed. Lunches are ordered based on what students request each day. If you would like to place restrictions on extra entrée orders, please contact the school. However, it is important that you also have this conversation with your child, as restrictions will only be implemented upon request.

Lunches from Home

When packing cold lunches, please keep in mind that use of the school refrigerators/freezers are not permitted. **Under regular circumstances, restaurant food, fast food and pop is not allowed. The office WILL NOT accept take-out deliveries of any kind.**

If a child is unable to tolerate the milk that is provided with every hot lunch, they should plan to bring a water bottle to lunch. Please notify the school office if your child is unable to make the choice on their own.

Students bringing nut-containing items will sit in a designated area at their lunch table to help prevent cross-contact.

Refrain from sending food in glass containers.

Microwave

- Students in grades 4-8 have access to microwaves. These are to be used to warm up leftover foods that take under 3 minutes. There is not enough time to cook microwave meals (Stouffers, Maria Calendar, Kraft Mac-n-Cheese, etc.) Students may not warm up anything containing peanuts/nuts.
- Students in K-3 are too young to operate the microwave independently so they should not bring in food that needs to be heated up.

Discipline

St. Martha Catholic School is committed to teaching Gospel values and virtue, which help our children live as a reflection of Christ. Our mission calls us to offer a Christ-centered, safe learning environment based on the teachings of the Catholic Church. Discipline is considered an element of moral guidance, not punishment. Every teacher and staff member share the responsibility of supporting the structure necessary to learning self-control. Students should develop moral awareness to understand how their behavior affects themselves and others. Students are encouraged to assume responsibility for their actions, develop self-control, and learn from the consequences of their inappropriate behavior. Teachers primarily use positive strategies; occasionally, however, other strategies are necessary for a child's growth. In school disciplinary situations, three principles prevail:

1. Children need to learn that consequences follow their decisions and actions.
2. Teachers use their educational expertise, experience, and discretionary wisdom to maintain order. All those involved must respect their authority.
3. In making a discipline decision, teachers keep in mind both what is good for the child and fair to his/her classmates. The efforts of the teacher to maintain this balance must likewise be respected by all parties.

Respectful behavior is speaking and acting with Christ in our hearts. When we show respect, we show courtesy, consideration for others as well as ourselves and we honor the rules of our families, school and nation. This is the expected behavior at St. Martha School.

Education in Virtue

St. Martha school implements the Educator in Virtue Program, developed by the Dominican Sisters of Mary. It is a clear, organized way of living a good, meaningful life. A Virtue is the habit of doing something good.

- **Stage 1: Learn**
Because it is the habit of doing good, one must first know virtue in order to live it; therefore, understanding what each virtue 'looks like' and 'sounds like' is essential.
- **Stage 2: Live**
By learning the virtues, one internalizes the characteristics of a good, integrated life and is then able to respond virtuously in all of life's circumstances.
- **Stage 3: Witness**
Living a virtuous life permits one to live in friendship with Christ—our fulfillment and hope. The habitus of virtue enables good acts to flow easily and the overflow of these provide one with a delight in doing the good.

More information can be found at: <https://openlightmedia.com/education-in-virtue/>

The rules and consequences below apply to actions in school, Kids Corner, and any school or parish sanctioned event.

General Rules

Category 1

1. Students will be respectful, responsible and ready to learn.
2. Gum chewing is never allowed at school.
3. Selling or trading of candy, chewing gum, toys, or any other item at school is not allowed.
4. Items having no relationship to school functions or personal need shall not be brought to school (examples: toys, personal music devices, cell phones, and electronic games.)
5. Students who bring cell phones to school must surrender them to the homeroom teacher at the beginning of the day. Phones will be returned to students at the end of the day. Abuse of this rule will result in the items being confiscated and held by the homeroom teacher until picked up by the parent.
6. Students will keep the school neat and clean.
7. Students will complete class and homework assignments and turn them in by the due date.
8. Students are expected to adhere to the uniform policy and dress code throughout the entire school day. (see uniform dress code in the school handbook)
9. Students will arrive to all of their classes on time.

Category 2

1. Students will practice hold to the principles of academic honesty and integrity. Plagiarism, cheating, copying work from another student, and use of Artificial Intelligence to complete work will not be tolerated.
2. Swearing and other inappropriate language is not allowed.
3. Disrespectful behavior, defiance, or uncooperative attitude toward any St. Martha faculty, staff, parish member, or volunteer will not be permitted. This may include, but not limited to, repeated eye rolling, shouting, refusal to follow directions, back-talk and arguing.
4. Vandalism or any destruction of school property will not be tolerated.
5. Students are not allowed to wander or be in unsupervised places.
6. Severe hitting, kicking, punching with intent cause harm is not permitted.
7. Social Media Use-Students may not use images of the staff, school building and church, or school logo on any forms of media or texting. Note: The minimum age for social medium platforms is 13.
8. Threats of violence to the school or students are not allowed in any form (verbal, written, text, social media). A threat assessment will be conducted immediately and the Meridian Township police will be notified.

Lunchroom Rules

1. Students will be respectful and responsible
2. Disrespectful behavior, defiance, or uncooperative attitude toward lunchroom personnel and volunteers is not permitted. This may include, but not limited to, repeated eye rolling, shouting, refusal to follow directions, back-talk and arguing.
3. All students will go to the lunchroom in an orderly manner
4. Students will not cut in line in the lunchroom.
5. Students will sit with their class at the assigned table until they are dismissed by school personnel.
6. Loud talking and horseplay is not allowed.
7. Students will use the microwave appropriately-only heating up leftovers.
8. Students will return trays and deposit litter in proper place.
9. Students will exit the lunchroom in orderly fashion.

Playground Rules

Category 1

1. Students will treat each other and the supervisors with respect and kindness.
2. Fair play is expected.
3. Playground equipment must be used correctly and safely.
4. Games involving tackling or throwing persons to the ground are prohibited. All play must be in a safe manner.
5. At the end of the recess, students will collect and put away balls and other items.
6. At the whistle, students will stop play and immediately line up at the designated spot.

Category 2

1. Disrespectful behavior, defiance, or uncooperative attitude toward playground supervisors and volunteers is not permitted. This may include, but not limited to, repeated eye rolling, shouting, refusal to follow directions, back-talk and arguing.
2. Language of students should be appropriated; foul language will not be tolerated.
3. Physical fighting is not permitted.
4. There will be no vandalism of playground equipment, including writing on equipment with chalk.
5. Students must stay within playground boundaries.
6. Students must go directly to the playground area.
7. Students may not leave the playground without notifying an adult.

Actions

Restorative Justice

Conflicts and behavioral issues will first be approached with restorative justice, which is a method discipline that focuses on repairing harm and rebuilding relationships. This practice is based on principles of empathy, respect, and accountability, encouraging students to understand the impact of their actions, take responsibility, and actively participate in the healing process. The goal of restorative justice is to “build community and repair relationships while supporting reflection, communication, and problem-solving skills for staff and students,” which can lead to more effective learning and teaching. It emphasizes dialogue and mutual agreement, involving all parties affected by a conflict, including victims, offenders, and the wider school community, to address issues collaboratively. This approach not only helps in managing individual incidents of misconduct but also fosters a culture of care, respect, and community, essential for educational success and social development. Appropriate consequences will be given when necessary.

Consequences

Be aware that any disrespect, destructive act, or inappropriate behavior will be dealt with accordingly. If a student does not meet his/her personal responsibility for good conduct, the school may discipline the student. The severity of repetitive nature of non-compliance behaviors will determine the appropriate consequences. To remediate unexpected behavior, the following actions may be taken (not necessarily in this order):

- Teacher-student conference
- Logical consequence (Example: If you throw food in the cafeteria, you will assist with cleaning the cafeteria)
- Notification to parents (phone call, email, or note in folder)
- Letter of apology to affected parties
- Develop a plan for remediation
- Loss of recess
- Silent lunch detention
- Loss of a privilege
- School service- cleaning, etc.

- Administrative referral
- Denial of participation in school activities, including field trips, and school sanctioned extra-curricular activities
- Parent Conference
- Sent home for the day
- School Probation/ Suspension/ Expulsion

Faculty and staff will only discuss information with you regarding your child. We will not discuss other children's consequences.

Please know that if a parent refuses to have their child receive a consequence for inappropriate behavior, a meeting with staff, administration, and pastor will occur.

Physical Conduct and Discriminatory Behavior Policy

Overview

St. Martha School is a place where all students are expected to show kindness, respect, and self-control. Physical aggression, unsafe play, and disrespectful or discriminatory language are not acceptable. These behaviors endanger student safety, interfere with learning, and go against the values of our faith and school community.

Reporting and Investigation

Incidents involving physical aggression, unsafe behavior, or discriminatory remarks may be:

- Directly witnessed by staff or faculty
- Reported by student, witness, or parent
- Discovered through observation, communication, or digital platforms

When an incident is not directly witnessed by staff, an investigation will be conducted to determine what occurred. This includes:

- Interviewing the student(s) involved
- Speaking with any witnesses
- Reviewing available information (video footage, digital messages, etc.)

Students are expected to cooperate honestly and respectfully during investigations. The school will use discretion and judgment to determine appropriate consequences based on the evidence gathered. False reporting or attempts to conceal truth will also be addressed as a disciplinary matter.

Categories:

- Severe Physical Aggression
- Rough Play / Unsafe Physical Contact
- Discriminatory or Offensive Language

Severe Physical Aggression (*Purposely striking someone with the intent to cause harm out of malice.*)

Examples Include:

- Intentional hitting, punching, slapping, kicking, or tripping
- Tackling, wrestling, or other forceful contact
- Physical retaliation or fights during conflict
- Repeated or targeted physical threats or actions

Consequences by Grade Level:

Grade Level	1st Offense	2nd Offense	3rd Offense	4th Offense
K-1	• Time out • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office referral	• Loss of privileges • Written/drawn reflection • Office referral • Parent meeting with teacher • Behavior contract	• Immediate removal from class • Written/drawn reflection • Office referral • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Behavior contract	• Out-of-school suspension (1 day), • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school
2-4	• Lunch/ recess detention • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office referral • Written/drawn reflection • Loss of privilege	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • 1-day in-school suspension • Written/drawn reflection • Office referral • Parent meeting with teacher • Behavior contract	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • Out-of-school suspension (1 day) • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Written/drawn reflection • Behavior contract • Counseling referral	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • Out-of-school suspension (2-3 days) • Written/drawn reflection • Parent meeting with teacher, principal, and pastor • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school
5-8	• Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office referral • 7:15 AM detention • Written reflection	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • 1-day in-school suspension • Written reflection • Office referral • Parent meeting with teacher • Behavior contract	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • Out-of-school suspension (1 day) • Written reflection • Office referral • Parent meeting with teacher and principal	• Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • Out-of-school suspension (2-3 days) • Parent meeting with teacher, principal, and pastor • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school

***Students who display severe physical aggression will be removed from activities where they are unable to participate safely and respectfully, including recess, sports, or group interactions.**

***As part of the restorative process, the student will write sincere letters of apology to those harmed by their actions.**

Rough Play / Unsafe Physical Contact

Examples Include:

- Hitting, shoving, grabbing, body checking, slapping in play
- “Play fighting” or mock wrestling
- Pushing in line
- Games involving rough or unsafe physical contact

Consequences by Grade Level:

Grade Level	1st Offense	2nd Offense	3rd Offense	4th+ Offense
K-1	• Redirection • Warning • Discussion with teacher	• Time out • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection	• Removal from activity • Loss of recess • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection • Behavior Contract	• Removal from activity • Loss of 2 recesses, • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection • Behavior Contract
2-4	• Redirection • Warning • Discussion with teacher	• Removal from activity • Time out and/ or loss of recess or activity time • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection	• Removal from activity • Time out and lunch detention • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection • Behavior Contract	• Removal from activity and from class for remainder of the day • Time out and lunch detention • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection • Behavior Contract
5-8	• Removal from activity • Warning • Discussion with teacher	• Removal from activity • Lunch detention, • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written reflection	• Removal from activity • Office referral • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • 7:15 AM detention • Written reflection • Behavior contract	• Treated as physical aggression • Immediate removal from class -sent home for the rest of the day • 7:15 AM Detention (3 days) • Written reflection • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Behavior contract

***Students who display roughhousing and unsafe physical contact will be removed from activities where they are unable to participate safely and respectfully, including recess, sports, or group interactions.**

***As part of the restorative process, the student will write sincere letters of apology to those harmed by their actions.**

Note: Rough play that results in injury or fear for others may be treated as severe physical aggression, regardless of grade level or intent.

Discriminatory or Offensive Language

Includes:

- Racial or ethnic slurs
- Sexist or gender-based comments
- Stereotyping or mocking language
- Any derogatory remark targeting a person's race, gender, culture, religion, or ability, etc...
- Swearing

Consequences by Grade Level:

Grade Level	1st Offense	2nd Offense	3rd Offense	4th Offense
K-1	• Discussion with teacher • Parent contact (Notice of Concern)	• Loss of privileges • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral	• Loss of privileges • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral • Behavior contract	• Loss of privileges • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral • Behavior contract • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school
2-4	• Discussion with teacher • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Written or drawn reflection	• Loss of privileges • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral	• Two lunch/ recess detentions • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral • Behavior contract	• Loss of privileges • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Office Referral • In school suspension • Behavior contract • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school
5-8	• Discussion with teacher • Office Referral • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • 7:15 AM detention • Written reflection	• Office Referral • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • 7:15 AM detentions (3) • Written reflection	• Office Referral • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • In school suspension • Written reflection • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Behavior contract	• Office Referral • Parent contact (Notice of Concern) • Out of School suspension • Parent meeting with teacher and principal • Behavior contract • Counseling referral • Possible removal from school

***As part of the restorative process, the student will write sincere letters of apology to those harmed by their actions.**

Restorative & Supportive Actions

In addition to consequences, students may participate in age-appropriate restorative practices, including:

- Written or verbal apologies
- Reflection activities (writing, drawing, or discussion)
- Guided restorative conversations
- Acts of service to restore trust or repair harm

Bullying Policy

Bullying

Bullying is a form of harassment. For the purpose of this policy, “bullying” is defined as: “The **repeated** intimidation of others by the real or threatened infliction of physical, verbal, written, electronically transmitted (text or social media), or emotional abuse, through verbal taunts, name-calling and put-downs, including ethnically-based or gender based verbal put-downs, extortion of money or possessions, inappropriate sexual comments, and exclusion from peer groups within school.” Bullying is intentional and demonstrates an imbalance of power. Such conduct is disruptive of the educational process and, therefore, bullying is not acceptable behavior in this school, and is prohibited.

The Difference between Bullying and Conflict

Conflict is a struggle between two or more people who appear to have different goals or desires. Conflict occurs naturally as we interact with one another. It is a normal part of life that we will not always agree with other people about the things we want, what we think, or what we want to do. Most conflicts arise in the moment, because people of the same relative amount of power see the same situation from two different points of view. In a conflict people may get frustrated and angry. During a conflict, emotions can escalate into a heated conflict. When one or both people have the skills to resolve the dispute so both sets of needs are met, the same conflict between the same two people most likely will not be repeated. If not, conflict might possibly continue for a long time.

Severe Hitting/Fighting/Striking

Purposely striking someone with the intent to cause harm out of malice.

Unwelcome Teasing/ Malice

Name-calling, insulting, spreading rumors or secrets, or other behavior that would hurt others’ feelings or make them feel bad about themselves. Can be spoken, written, or drawn and includes texting and social media.

Threats

An expression of intention to inflict evil, injury, or damage.

Exclusion

Starting rumors, telling others not to be friends with someone, or to be purposefully left out.

Rough Play/Hitting

Pushing, tripping, slapping, grabbing, etc.

Cyberbullying

Sending messages with threatening or hurtful language through email or text. Gossiping about someone on social media or leaving insulting comments. Creating fake email or social media accounts to trick someone. Taking embarrassing photos of someone without their permission and posting them on social media.

In cases where misconduct and bullying are reported (not witnessed by a staff member), an investigation will take place. Based on the assembled information appropriate actions will be taken.

Final Note: Discipline at St. Martha School is guided by compassion, fairness, and a desire to help students grow. While consequences are necessary, our greater goal is always the formation of character rooted in love and respect for others

Sexual Harassment

1. Verbal: the making of written or verbal sexual innuendoes, suggestive comments, jokes of a sexual nature, sexual propositions or threats to a fellow student, staff member, or other person associated with the school.
2. Nonverbal: Causing the placement of sexually suggestive objects, pictures, or graphic commentaries in the school environment or the making of sexually suggestive or insulting gestures, sounds, leering, whistling, and the like to a fellow student, staff member, or other person associated with the school
3. Physical Contact: Threatening or causing unwanted touching, contact, or attempts at the same, including a pat, pinching, pushing the body, with a fellow student, staff member, or other persons associated with the school.

If it is determined that a student has been in violation of the Harassment Policy the following actions will be taken:

1. First Violation: A verbal warning will be given to the student. Any violations should be reported to the principal. Principal will record the violation and notify parents.
2. Second Violation: The student will be suspended from school immediately. A minimum of a one-day suspension will follow. Conference between student, parent(s), principal, and pastor will determine when student will be readmitted to school.
3. Any further violations will result in longer suspensions and possible expulsion from school. This will be determined by the principal and pastor.

Kids' Corner
(Before and After School
Care)

Saint Martha childcare programs do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, ethnic or national origin.

Saint Martha reserves the right not to enroll, or to request that parents withdraw any student whose behavioral needs cannot be met given the staff, materials, and facilities that are present at Saint Martha Before & After School Care Programs.

PROGRAM OBJECTIVES

- To help meet the childcare needs of Saint Martha School Families.
- To provide a safe, nurturing environment which your children will find enjoyable and enriching.
- To recognize and respect the uniqueness of each child.
- To maintain ongoing communication between our staff and parents.

Hours of Operation

- 7:20 A.M.-7:50 A.M. and 3:25 P.M. - 6:00 P.M.

The following must be completed and turned in prior to a child attending:

- Registration form
- Emergency card
- Parent Notification of Licensing Handbook

Sign-in, Sign-out Procedures

In the morning, parents must accompany their preschoolers, kindergartners and first graders into the building and sign them in. Older children may sign themselves in.

At the end of the day, children will only be released to parents or persons authorized to pick them up as stated on their Emergency Card or Pick-Up Authorization Card. Parents or persons authorized to pick them up must sign their name and time of pickup on the sign-out sheet. These regulations are for the safety and protection of the children. Parents should only call Kids' Corner in the event of an emergency or a later than 6:00 P.M. pick-up.

Late Pick-ups

Closing time is at 6:00 P.M. After the first 15 minutes, if the parent has not arrived or has not called (517-349- 3322), the staff will call the names on the emergency card to come pick-up the children. The charges for late pickup are \$1/per minute beginning at 6:00 P.M.

Before Care

St. Martha School teachers provide before school care daily, beginning at 7:20am. Teachers will rotate and the classroom that is hosting before care for the month will be posted at the designated drop off location. **If your child must arrive to school prior to 7:50am, they must go to the before care classroom.** No child should be waiting on the school grounds alone or unsupervised

Fee Schedule

	<u>1st Student</u>	<u>2 Students</u>	<u>3+ Students</u>
Before school care	\$800 per school year	\$1300	\$1500
After school care	\$2200 per school year (\$183 monthly)	\$3700 (\$308 monthly)	\$5200 (\$330 monthly)
Drop-in a.m.	\$6 per day per child		
Drop-in p.m.	\$15 per day	\$25	\$35

Billing for Before Care/Kids Corner

All fees for childcare will be paid through Blackbaud.

If you are using the care programs as a drop in, you will be billed monthly. Payments must be up to date in order for you

****All Policies in this Handbook pertain to Kid's Corner.**

St. Martha School Cellphone, Chromebook, and Technology Acceptable Use Policy

****Please read the separate handbook and sign and turn in the last page of that policy.****

St. Martha School U.S. Copyright Information

Copyright is a form of protection provided by the laws of the United States (title 17, U.S. Code) to the authors of “original works of authorship” including literary, dramatic, musical, artistic, and certain other intellectual works. This protection is available to both published and unpublished works. Section 106 of the 1976 Copyright Act generally gives the owner of copyright the exclusive right to do and to authorize others to do the following:

- To reproduce the work in copies or phonorecords
- To prepare derivative works based upon the work
- To distribute copies or phonorecords of the work to the public by sale or other transfer of ownership, or by rental, lease or lending
- To perform the work publicly, in the case of literary, musical, dramatic, and choreographic works, pantomimes, and motion pictures and other audiovisual works
- To display the work publicly, in the case of literary, musical, dramatic, and choreographic works, pantomimes, and pictorial, graphic, or sculptural works, including the individual images of a motion picture or other audiovisual work; and
- In the case of sound records*, to perform the work publicly by means of a digital audio transmission.

In addition, certain authors of works of visual art have the rights of attribution and integrity as described in section 106A of the 1976 Copyright Act. For further information, request Circular 40, Copyright Registration for Works of the Visual Arts.

It is illegal for anyone to violate any of the rights provided by the copyright law to the owner of copyright. These rights however are not unlimited in scope. Sections 107 through 121 of the 1976 Copyright Act establish limitations on these rights. In some cases, these limitations are specified exemptions from copyright liability. One major limitation is the doctrine of “fair use” which is given a statutory basis in section 107 of the 1976 Copyright Act. In other instances, the limitation takes the form of a “compulsory license” under which certain limited uses of copyright works are permitted upon payment of specified royalties and compliance with statutory conditions. For further information about the limitations of any of these rights, consult the copyright law or write to the Copyright Office.

***Note:** Sound recordings are defined in the law as “works that result from the fixation of a series of musical, spoken, or other sounds, but not including the sounds accompanying a motion picture or other audiovisual work.” Common examples include recordings of music, drama, or lectures. A sound recording is not the same as a phonorecord. A phonorecord is the physical object in which works of authorship are embodied. The word “phonorecord” includes cassette tapes, CD’s, LPs, 45 r.p.m. disks, as well as other formats.

Diocesan Requirement

(please sign and return this page to school)

St. Martha School is committed to maintaining a safe and respectful learning environment at the school. A student's behavior, whether at school or away from school, can affect the safety of the student or of other students, or can be a sign of significant issue in the student's life, or can affect the overall well-being of the school community. St. Martha School is a Catholic learning community in which parents, students, administration, faculty and staff mutually pledge to assist young people to grow toward healthy safe, moral, Catholic maturity. For this reason, notwithstanding any other provision of this handbook, parents and legal guardians agree that St. Martha School will uphold our discipline policy to include any and all actions occurring both in and out of school.

Family Name: _____

Names and Grades of Children at Saint Martha School:

Updated Information for 25-26

- p. 15 Food Allergies, Intolerances, and Nut Restrictions
- p. 15 EpiPen Policy for Students with Severe Allergies
- 9. 19 FACTS SIS
- p. 20 Purchasing Lunches
- p. 24 Physical Conduct and Discriminatory Behavior Policy
- p. 32 St. Martha School Cellphone, Chromebook, and Technology Acceptable Use Policy (Separate policy sent home).

Parents/ Guardians: Please initial below:

- _____ I have read and discussed the policies outlined in the St. Martha School Handbook with my child(ren). I understand that failure to follow the guidelines, expectations, and procedures described may result in disciplinary action. I agree to support the school in reinforcing these rules and expectations with my child(ren) and will partner with the school to promote a positive and respectful learning environment.

Parent Signature

Date

For Students in Grades 4-8 ONLY:

I have read and understand the contents of the 2025-2026 St. Martha School Handbook. I will respect and follow these rules while I am a student at St. Martha School.

Student Signatures:

Date:
